```
<html>
  <head>
    <meta charset="utf-8" />
    <title>The easiest page you'll ever create</title>
  </head>
  <body>
      <h1>Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet</h1>
      {$mainPara}
  </body>
</html>
EOS;
```

The code above will render the same page as before, but now we're building the HTML dynamically by injecting one HTML fragment into another to form a complete document. It's a *very* simplified example, but this is essentially how you'll be constructing your pages from scratch.

The Old-Fashioned Way

An alternative method exists to the string handling demonstrated above, which is not recommended (by me) in modern PHP but nevertheless still exists out there in the wild lands of Legacy Code. All PHP is wrapped in special tags, which we covered way back in Chapter 1, "Getting Started," and every source code file you create must have a valid opening tag even if it contains nothing but PHP code. The opening tags are `<?php`, a short form `<?` (this "short opening tag" is not recommended and is prohibited by the PSR-1 standard because it can be disabled by ini directive), and `<?=` (the "short echo tag" is equivalent to `<?php echo`), and the closing tag is `?>` (which can and should be omitted in pure PHP files to avoid accidental echoing of newline characters triggering headers). Looks a little bit like markup, right? This is because PHP was originally intended to be interspersed with HTML: the PHP interpreter will treat anything not wrapped in PHP tags as text to be emitted immediately (though you can of course switch on output buffering before any text characters are encountered), and only the text wrapped in PHP tags is parsed as code. This allows you to pepper your HTML with PHP, like this: